Gerardo Cipriano

Cloud Engineer | Microsoft Azure, AKS, Azure DevOps, Kubernetes, Terraform

Italy | linkedin.com/in/gerardo-cipriano | github.com/gerardocipriano | gerardocipriano.github.io

SUMMARY

Cloud Engineer with 3 years running Kubernetes platforms on Microsoft Azure and Google Cloud, and 8+ years in IT since 2018. I operate Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS) and Google Kubernetes Engine (GKE) clusters, build CI/CD on Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions and GitLab CI, and deliver with GitOps (Argo CD) and Terraform. Two years as a system administrator on the Microsoft stack: Windows Server, Active Directory, Hyper-V and Microsoft 365. Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104) since 2022, renewed and valid through Dec 2027.

SKILLS

Microsoft Azure: Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), Azure DevOps (pipelines), Azure Container Registry (ACR), Azure networking

Kubernetes: Helm, Gateway API, Ingress, Kubernetes RBAC, Network Policy, cluster upgrades, Google Kubernetes Engine (GKE), on-premises Kubernetes

Infrastructure as Code (IaC) and GitOps: Terraform (modular, on Google Cloud and Azure), Argo CD, Argo CD Image Updater, Kargo, Kustomize

CI/CD: Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins (lab)

Scripting and containers: Bash, Python, Git, Docker, Linux

Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana

Microsoft systems: Windows Server, Active Directory, Group Policy (GPO), WSUS, Microsoft Hyper-V, Microsoft 365, VMware ESXi, Veeam Backup & Replication

Google Cloud: Cloud SQL, Cloud Storage (GCS), Certificate Manager, Cloud DNS, Cloud Run, Cloud Build

EXPERIENCE

Cloud Engineer / DevOps Specialist

Dinova S.r.l., Bologna, Italy | Sep 2023 - Present

- Run CI/CD pipelines on Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions and GitLab CI across several client environments, and remove pipeline bottlenecks with Python and Bash scripts.
- Operate Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS) and GKE environments: storage, networking, container registry, monitoring and alerting, and Kubernetes RBAC.
- Migrated legacy virtual machine workloads to containerized microservices on AKS and GKE.
- Implemented GitOps continuous delivery with Argo CD and Argo CD Image Updater in several production environments, so new container images reach the live environment without manual steps.
- Write modular Terraform (Infrastructure as Code) reused across client projects on Azure and Google Cloud.
- Upgraded Kubernetes from v1.24 to v1.30, six minor versions, on on-prem and cloud clusters with zero downtime.
- Migrated traffic routing from Kubernetes Ingress to Gateway API, and moved applications between clusters without service disruption.
- Designed Helm charts for clients moving to microservices, with rollback support and per-environment configuration.
- Explore AI agent orchestration and LLM-based automation inside DevOps workflows.

System Administrator

F.T.P. S.r.l., Formigine, Italy | Jul 2020 - Sep 2022

- Administered Microsoft and virtual infrastructure for small and mid-sized businesses: Windows Server, Active Directory, Group Policy (GPO), WSUS, DHCP, DNS, Microsoft Hyper-V and VMware ESXi.
- Migrated client organizations to Microsoft 365 on my own, and managed Microsoft 365 and Google Workspace tenants.

- Reorganized Active Directory, GPO, WSUS and Hyper-V environments to Microsoft best practices.
- Ran backup and disaster recovery with Veeam Backup & Replication, and managed Sophos and Fortinet FortiGate firewalls and Libraesva and Sophos email antispam.

IT Help Desk Technician
GPI S.p.A., Modena, Italy | Mar 2018 - Jun 2020

- Provided on-site and remote hardware and software support for public-sector clients: City of Modena, Policlinico di Modena hospital, University of Modena and Reggio Emilia (UniMoRe) and AUSL Modena.
- Rolled out the move from Windows XP and Windows 7 to Windows 10 at Policlinico di Modena and UniMoRe to meet AGID (Italian Digital Agency) requirements.

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104), Microsoft | First certified 2022, renewed Dec 2025, valid through Dec 2027

Google Cloud Certified Associate Cloud Engineer (ACE), Google Cloud | First certified Nov 2023, valid through Nov 2027

Earlier certifications: Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA); Microsoft 365 Identity and Services (Exam MS-100)

PROJECTS

GitOps lab in one command (2026)
github.com/gerardocipriano/gke-gitlab-argocd-all-in-one-setup

Bash tool that bootstraps a complete GitOps environment on a local kind cluster or on GKE with one command: GitLab CE as the Git server, Argo CD with the app-of-apps pattern, and Kargo promoting releases from dev to staging to prod. Includes a 10-step guided demo and a guided teardown.

bekky, encrypted workstation backups (2026)
github.com/gerardocipriano/bekky

Backup and restore of OS configuration to Google Cloud Storage: AES-256 encryption with PBKDF2 at 600,000 iterations, deduplication before encryption, secrets in a separate archive, Nearline storage with lifecycle rules and versioning to keep storage cost low, scheduled runs with alerts, automated testing with bats.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Information Systems Technology (Tecnologie dei sistemi informatici), University of Bologna, Cesena, Italy | 2021 - 2024

High School Diploma, Telecommunications Technician, IIS F. Corni, Modena, Italy | 2012 - 2017 | Grade 92/100

LANGUAGES

Italian (native) | English (professional working proficiency, B2/C1)